

THE FILMING DAY GUIDE

How to shoot your ads and your sales video in one session

APEX ACQ | APEXACQ.CO

Read this first (2 minutes)

You're about to film the stuff that makes your phone ring. Here's the good news: **there is no script to memorize**. Guys who hate cameras tell us this is way easier than they expected, because all you're doing is answering questions about your own work. You've been doing this trade for years. You already know every answer.

This guide covers two things:

1. **The short ads.** 5 to 7 clips, 30 to 60 seconds each. These run on Facebook and Instagram and get homeowners to stop scrolling.
2. **The sales video (VSL).** One longer video, 2 to 5 minutes. This sits on your landing page and does the convincing before anyone ever calls you.

If you've hired a videographer, hand them this whole guide. The tech specs they need are on the last page. If it's just you and your phone, that works too. Some of the best-performing videos on landing pages like yours are 3-minute webcam recordings. Done beats perfect, every time.

How the session runs (about 60 minutes)

Someone runs the session as the prompter. That's your Apex contact on a video call, your videographer, or even your office manager. Their job is simple: read you one prompt at a time, keep you on topic, and make you redo your opening line once. That's it.

Time	What's happening
First 10 min	Warm up. Talk about your best recent job and the worst horror story a customer brought you. Camera off. This gets you talking like yourself.
Next 25 min	Film the ads. One idea at a time.
Next 15 min	Film the sales video. Question and answer style.
Next 5 min	The review video (easiest one, see Part 3).
Last 5 min	B-roll. Walking shots, the truck, the crew, the work.

Your personalized prompt list arrives before the shoot. It's built from what your actual customers say in reviews and on calls. The examples below show you the shape of it.

PART 1: THE SHORT ADS

The only rule: think about your first sentence, then just talk

Every ad has three beats:

Beat 1: Stop the right homeowner from scrolling. This is your first sentence. It's the only part worth thinking about before the camera rolls. Take 5 seconds, get it in your head, then go. A good first sentence does two things: says what you actually do, and names the result the homeowner wants.

Weak: "Hi, we're a roofing company in Red Deer."

Strong: "If your roof is 20 years old and you're crossing your fingers every hailstorm, this is for you."

Beat 2: Keep talking for about 30 seconds. No script. Just stay on the one topic. If the prompt is about insurance claims, talk about insurance claims. What confuses people, what you do differently, what happened on a real job last month. You already know this stuff cold.

Beat 3: Land the plane. Finish with a simple next step: "If that sounds like your place, hit the button below and we'll take a look." Done.

The retake rule

Always redo your first take. Not because it was bad. Because the second one is always better. You've warmed up, you know where the sentence is going, and it comes out like you instead of like a hostage reading a note. Everyone's second take wins. Plan on it.

Example prompts (yours will be customized)

- The customer who got burnt by another contractor before they found you
- The thing homeowners always get wrong about [your trade]
- The job you're proudest of this year and why
- What actually happens when someone calls you (walk them through it)
- The warning sign in their house they're probably ignoring right now

Same idea can become two ads. "Stop overpaying for emergency callouts" and "catch it before it breaks" are the same message pointed at different people. If the prompter asks you to say the same thing a different way, that's why.

PART 2: THE SALES VIDEO (VSL)

This one's longer, but the method is even easier: **it's an interview**. The prompter asks, you answer, the questions get cut out in the edit. What's left looks like you talking straight to the homeowner.

The questions come in this order. Only the first answer needs any practice.

1. The opener (the only part to run twice before filming). Who is this for and what's going on in their head right now? Shape: *"If you're a homeowner in [your area] dealing with [problem], [problem], and [problem], you're who we built this for. I'm [name], owner of [business], and here's how we make sure [the result they want]."* Your reviews and job photos get flashed on screen while you say it.

2. How you work. - What have your customers usually tried before they call you, and why did it let them down? - What's the first thing you do on every job that fixes that? - What do most companies skip after the job that you don't? The follow-through, the warranty, the check-in. - Then wrap it: "So, two things. First we [step one]. Then we [step two]."

3. The questions you hear on every single quote. Answer the 3 or 4 most common ones, most common first. How long does it take, do you handle permits and insurance, what if something goes wrong after. For results, say what customers tell you afterwards in their own words. "Most people tell us they wish they'd called sooner" beats any percentage.

4. Who you are (15 seconds, and make it about them). Not a brag, a reassurance: *"Because we've done [X jobs] around [area] over [Y years], you're not the test run."*

5. The close. *"So if you want [the result] and you're done with [the problem], fill out the short form below or give us a call. We'll tell you straight if we're the right fit."*

Two things to leave OUT of this video: your price (that's a phone conversation, and you don't want to refilm when it changes) and anything you can't back up. If it's not true on your worst week, don't say it.

PART 3: THE REVIEW VIDEO (3 minutes, easiest win of the day)

Open your Google reviews on a screen. Hit record with your face in the corner. Scroll through and talk about the customers you remember:

"Here's Wendy. She'd been burnt by another company before us. Here's what we did for her place..."

Two or three minutes, done. No prep, no polish. Don't let how easy it is fool you. This little video earns its spot on your landing page, and it takes less time than your coffee break.

PART 4: B-ROLL SHOT LIST

B-roll is the footage we layer over your talking. Grab 10 to 20 seconds of each:

- You walking a jobsite (toward camera, phone steady)
 - The truck, branding visible
 - The crew working, real work, not posed
 - Close-ups of the craft: hands, tools, the finished detail
 - Before and after of a recent job
 - **The landmark shot:** you in front of a main road or landmark everyone in your town knows. Locals trust faces they see in places they drive past every day. This one matters more than it sounds.
 - You on the phone or greeting a customer (can be staged, keep it natural)
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FOR THE VIDEOGRAPHER: TECH SPECS

Formats: Shoot everything in 4K. Frame the ads and review video **vertical (9:16)**, safe for Reels and Stories. Shoot the VSL **horizontal (16:9)**, framed center so we can also crop a vertical version. If shooting one format only, go vertical for ads, horizontal for the VSL.

Audio: Lav mic on the owner. Clean audio is non-negotiable, it matters more than the picture. No music on raw files.

Light: Daylight, sun on the face, never behind. Outside beats inside. Golden hour if the schedule allows, but don't chase it at the cost of the session.

First frame: For at least a few ad takes, put trust in the background of the opening shot: the crew, the truck, the jobsite. If you film a customer testimonial at any point, hold a split screen or cutaway of the owner in the first 3 seconds so viewers connect the face to the business.

Direction style: You are the prompter. Feed one idea at a time from the prompt list. Let them talk past stumbles, do not stop takes for small flubs. Always run the opener twice. If an answer ran long, ask "say that again, shorter." Keep them standing and moving, a still body makes a flat voice.

Delivery: Raw, ungraded files. Separate audio track if recorded. WeTransfer or Drive link to your Apex contact. The edit, captions, and cutdowns are handled on the Apex side.

IF SOMEONE ELSE IS EDITING: WHAT THE FINISHED VIDEOS SHOULD LOOK LIKE

Default is simple: send raw files to John and the edit gets done for you. But if your videographer or an editor is cutting these, hand them this page. Your Apex contact sends 1 or 2 reference clips with the prompt list so everyone can see the target before cutting.

The short ads (30 to 60 seconds, vertical 9:16): - Open on the strongest take of the first sentence. The hook also goes on screen as big text for the first 3 seconds. - Tighten with jump cuts and punch-ins. A 3 minute raw take should cut to 30 to 60 seconds. Cut the dead air, keep the energy. - **Captions burned in, always.** Most people watch with the sound off. Big, readable, high contrast, and kept out of the bottom fifth of the frame so app buttons don't cover them. - Keep it human. Leave the small stumbles and the ums in. If it gets polished to news anchor smooth, it stops working. Cut mistakes, not personality. - End card, 2 to 3 seconds: your logo, your phone number, and the next step ("Tap below" or "Call us today"). - No stock footage, no AI imagery, no cheesy transitions. Real footage only.

The sales video (VSL, horizontal 16:9, 2 to 4 minutes): - Cut the prompter's questions out so it plays as the owner talking straight to the homeowner. - **Spend most of the editing effort on the first 30 seconds.** While the owner runs the opener, flash proof on screen: your Google reviews, real job photos, the trucks and crew. The rest of the video can stay almost bare. - Layer B-roll over the talking wherever it matches what's being said. Talking head alone is fine for the back half. - Captions on, same rules as the ads. - Light background music is fine here, kept low. None on the ads. - Thumbnail: pick the most visually engaging working moment, not a frozen mid-word face.

The review video: - Captions burned in. That's the whole edit. Keep it raw, that's why it works.

Brand basics: your business colors for text highlights and the end card. Logo small in a corner or on the end card only, never plastered over the footage.

OWNER'S CHECKLIST FOR THE DAY

- Phone or camera charged, lens wiped
- Wear what you wear to work. Logo shirt if you have one. Don't dress up

- Location: outside, near your landmark or an active jobsite
- Quiet enough to talk without shouting
- Your prompt list from Apex (sent the day before)
- Coffee. Nothing else

Mess up a line? Say it again. Nobody ever sees the bad takes.

Questions before the shoot? Message John directly.

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